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Trump muddles messages on Iran

Pakistan prepares for new talks as Tehran’s attendance uncertain

By Munir Ahmed, Jon Gambrell and David Rising
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump offered mixed messages Monday about the path ahead for the U.S. war against Iran, declaring that he was in no rush to end the conflict while also express-

ing confidence that further negotiations with Tehran will soon take place in Pakistan.

With the 14-day ceasefire set to expire Wednesday, Trump whipsawed in telephone interviews and social media posts between measured optimism that a deal could soon be reached and warning that “lots of bombs” will “start going off” if there’s no agreement before the ceasefire deadline.

Trump indicated that he still expects to dispatch his negotiating team, led by Vice President

JD Vance, to Pakistan’s capital of Islamabad for a second round of talks, even as Iran insisted it would not take part until Trump dialed back his demands. Trump insisted he feels no pressure to end the war until Iran agrees to his terms.

“I am under no pressure whatsoever,” Trump said on his Truth Social platform, “although, it will all happen, relatively quickly!”

Iran’s chief negotiator and parliament speaker, Mohammed Bagher Qalibaf, accused the United States of wanting Iran to surrender and

added that on the contrary, Iran has been preparing “to reveal new cards on the battlefield.”

“We do not accept negotiations under the shadow of threats,” Qalibaf wrote in a post on X early Tuesday.

Pakistani officials moved ahead with preparations for a new round of talks between the U.S. and Iran as the tenuous ceasefire was further strained over the weekend by renewed conflict around the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump told Bloomberg News he

was “highly unlikely” to renew the truce.

Tensions flared after the U.S. Navy attacked and seized a ship Sunday that it said was trying to evade its blockade of Iranian ports. On Saturday, Iran fired at vessels and abruptly stopped traffic in the strait, abandoning its promise to allow some ships to pass and claiming the U.S. was not holding up its side of the ceasefire.

The U.S. actions are “incom-

See **IRAN** on Page A8

Suit over National Guard dismissed

Judge grants motion to halt litigation sparked by Illinois mobilization

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Nearly seven months after federal troops were preparing to deploy to Chicago during Operation Midway Blitz, a federal judge on Monday granted a motion to dismiss the state’s lawsuit over the mobilization amid assurances that the presidential orders have been rescinded.

In making her ruling, U.S. District Judge April Perry said that even though President Donald Trump had threatened on social media to “come back” to Chicago with troops eventually, she cannot issue “advisory opinions” about hypothetical orders that might happen in the future.

The judge also noted that the “facts on the ground have changed substantially” since last fall, when hundreds of federalized troops were poised to help protect federal agents as they carried out deportation operations in the Chicago area.

“Things in Chicago are calm,” Perry said. “They have been calm for many many months, and while that certainly could change in the future, there is no threat of that happening anytime soon.”

The decision ends litigation that made national headlines in early October at the height of Operation Midway Blitz. After the Illinois attorney general and city of Chicago filed suit, Perry held a daylong, emotionally charged hearing on Oct. 9 that ended with her issuing a historic restraining order blocking the deployment.

Months later, the U.S. Supreme Court denied a request from the Trump administration to allow the Republican president to deploy troops to Illinois streets while the court battle played out, saying they had “failed to identify a source of authority that would allow the mili-

See **GUARD** on Page A2

McHenry residents brace for flooding

More than 100 volunteers spent Sunday filling and stacking sandbags across Nunda Township as officials warn the Fox River could reach major flood levels within days in McHenry County. So far, 60,000 sandbags have been filled. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Bears start offseason work at Halas Hall

Veteran players returned to work Monday at Halas Hall as they began the team’s voluntary offseason program. QB Caleb Williams was among them after coach Ben Johnson asked him to take some time off to “reset.” **Chicago Sports**



Hanging by a thread

Only 250 professional sewers remain in Chicago area. These local tailors think they know why fewer young Americans are pursuing the field

Above: Figo Topal, 65, tailors clothing on Thursday in his shop, Devrim Cleaners, in Chicago’s Lincoln Square neighborhood.
BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

By Audrey Pachuta | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Figo Topal has plenty of room to alter clothes in his Lincoln Square storefront, but he chooses to keep his sewing machine in front of the window.

Most people think he sits there for the good natural light, but for him, being spotted by passersby on the residential Rockwell Street sidewalk is much more important.

“People need to see you work,” he said, his red-framed glasses sliding down to the bridge of his nose as he focused intensely on hemming a pair of beige pants. “That’s the key in this business.”

Topal is considering retiring this year. But the 65-year-old stands as a bastion in a job he believes could become obsolete. Back in the day, he said, when everyone smoked cigarettes in restaurants and no one worked from home, his business flourished. The demand for dry cleaning and alterations was overwhelming.

Now, he said, “the world is different.”

Topal is one of just 250 professional sewers in the Chicago metropolitan area, according to the latest data available from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics in 2024. And as Topal and many other skilled trade workers near the end of their

See **TAILORS** on Page A4

Some CPS parents push against May Day deal

Rally at Pilsen school airs concerns about civic engagement day

By Audrey Pachuta and Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

More than two dozen Chicago Public Schools parents and community members gathered outside a Pilsen elementary school Monday morning, voicing concerns over the district’s decision to hold a day of civic engagement on May 1.

While classes will remain in session, CPS reached an agreement last week to provide transportation to students who chose to participate in an afternoon

rally, and to allow teachers to implement a curriculum on civic engagement.

For weeks, the Chicago Teachers Union had been pushing for May 1 to be designated as a teacher-directed professional development day — joining a national action for “no school, no work, no shopping.” After opposition from CPS leadership, last week’s deal was seen as a compromise.

But some parents are pushing back.

Judy Velez, a CPS parent with a daughter in second grade, said there was a “need for transparency” in the decision-making process and in what could be included in the civic engagement



Leonor Arellano, center, and other Chicago Public Schools parents, rally on Monday outside Cooper Dual Language Academy in the Pilsen neighborhood in opposition to CPS declaring May 1 as a day of civic engagement. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

See **MAY** on Page A4

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 76 L: 50 **WED.** H: 69 L: 53 **THU.** H: 80 L: 63
Complete details on Page A12

INDEX

Almanac A8
Arts & Living B7
Comics B10-11
Crossword B11
Editorials A5
Horoscope B10
Nation & World B4
Obituaries A8
Television B9

178th year No. 111
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